

See also

Read about how different kinds of insects go through metamorphosis (78–85).

Frogs can lay thousands of eggs at a time.

Growing limbs

A young tadpole has fishlike gills and a long tail for swimming. It feeds on the mother's unfertilized eggs, and after a few weeks it develops limbs. This process is called

metamorphosis.

Adult life

The frog is now fully grown. It lives among layers of leaves, making it hard to spot in the rain forest. The best way to find one is to listen for the calls of the males guarding their territory.

Froglet

The tadpole soon loses its gills and develops lungs so it can breathe air. It is now called a froglet, and it begins to eat small insects. It remains near the pool until it loses its tail.

Axolotl

Unlike other amphibians, this large salamander has external gills and a fishlike tail. It does not undergo a full metamorphosis and lives its whole life in water.

Midwife toad

This male frog carries a string of eggs on his back, with the egg string wrapped around his ankles. He walks into shallow water when they are ready to hatch.

Darwin's frog

Just before his tadpoles hatch, the father gathers them into his throat sac. He holds them until they have hatched and the froglets can hop out on their own.